RICHFIELD HACKATHON 2026

STUDENT FINAL CHECKLIST

1. User Types & Authentication(10 points)

- ☐ We have all 4 required user types: Student, Alumni, Business and Administrator.
- ☐ Each user type has the correct permissions and access for its role.
- ☐ Role-based access control (RBAC) is enforced by the backend, not only hidden in the interface.
- ☐ Student registration is restricted to the required student email domain.
- ☐ We have a researched and clearly explained alumni verification process.
- ☐ Business accounts go through an approval step before receiving full access.
- ☐ Administrator accounts are provisioned securely and separately from normal user registration.
- ☐ We are NOT using hard-coded credentials, fake authentication, mock login screens or placeholder logins.

2. Administrator Panel(8 points)

- ☐ Administrators can approve, suspend and remove users.
- ☐ Administrators can manage business approval and alumni verification.
- ☐ Administrators can moderate platform content.
- ☐ Administrators can create, edit and publish events, and this function is admin-only.
- ☐ Administrators can oversee and approve opportunity listings.
- ☐ Administrators can access platform analytics.
- ☐ Administrators can broadcast announcements to users.

3. User Profiles(8 points)

- ☐ Student and alumni profiles include useful fields such as skills, experience, badges and certifications.

- [ ] Student/alumni profiles can include links or evidence such as GitHub and a CV.
- [ ] Business users have a proper company profile.
- [ ] Users have profile visibility/privacy controls.
- [ ] The platform supports skill endorsements.
- [ ] The platform supports written recommendations.

4. Connections & Social Features(8 points)

- [ ] Users can send connection requests.
- [ ] Users can accept or decline connection requests.
- [ ] The activity feed is personalised and differs appropriately by user role.
- [ ] Users can create text posts.
- [ ] The platform supports short-form video content.
- [ ] Users can send direct messages.
- [ ] Users can comment on content.
- [ ] Users can react to content.

5. Opportunity Listings & Career Features(8 points)

- [ ] Business users can post opportunities.
- [ ] Opportunity posts pass through an administrator approval step.
- [ ] Students can browse opportunities.
- [ ] Students can filter opportunities.
- [ ] Students can apply for opportunities.
- [ ] There is a career pathway explorer linked to the student's programme.

- [ ] Institutional events are listed in the platform.
- [ ] Users receive relevant notifications about opportunities/events where appropriate.

6. Onboarding, Chatbot & Profile Assistant(8 points)

- [ ] An AI profile assistant guides users through onboarding step-by-step.
- [ ] The assistant gives context-aware feedback rather than generic fixed responses.
- [ ] The chatbot remains available as an ongoing resource after onboarding.
- [ ] First-time users receive an interactive app tutorial.
- [ ] The AI/chatbot uses a genuine AI or conversational framework and is NOT just a hard-coded script.

7. Data Analytics Dashboards(6 points)

- [ ] There is a distinct Student dashboard.
- [ ] There is a distinct Business dashboard.
- [ ] There is a distinct Administrator dashboard.
- [ ] The dashboards are role-specific rather than one generic page reused for everyone.
- [ ] Dashboard information is shown visually using charts, graphs or other visual indicators.

8. Additional Technical Features(4 points)

- [ ] Real-time notifications are implemented using WebSockets, push notifications or another genuine real-time method rather than polling.
- [ ] Job/opportunity matching uses skills and/or programme information to make smart recommendations.
- [ ] NLP is used to assist profile building from a CV and/or free text.
- [ ] Video functionality includes compression, transcoding and thumbnail generation.

9. Technology Stack & Architecture(5 points)

- ☐ We can explain why we chose our mobile development framework for this project.
- ☐ We can explain why our database choice suits the project, including SQL vs NoSQL reasoning where relevant.
- ☐ We have a clear system architecture diagram that accurately reflects how our solution works.

10. Source Code Repository(5 points)

- ☐ Our repository has a README that explains the project overview.
- ☐ The README includes clear setup/run instructions.
- ☐ The README explains the main technology choices.
- ☐ Our commit history shows meaningful work throughout the project rather than one final upload.
- ☐ All team members have meaningful, visible contributions in the commit history.

11. Working Prototype Quality(10 points)

- ☐ Our MAIN application is a mobile prototype, not a web or desktop app used as a substitute.
- ☐ The mobile build runs on a real device or emulator.
- ☐ There are no critical failures that prevent the main workflow from being demonstrated.
- ☐ We can demonstrate the Student user journey end-to-end.
- ☐ We can demonstrate the Alumni user journey end-to-end.
- ☐ We can demonstrate the Business user journey end-to-end.
- ☐ We can demonstrate the Administrator user journey/end-to-end admin functionality.
- ☐ The administrator panel is functional (it may be mobile, web or desktop).
- ☐ The overall user experience is polished and understandable.

12. PowerPoint Presentation(10 points)

- ☐ Our presentation contains at least 15 slides.
- ☐ We clearly explain the problem statement and how our solution responds to the scenario.
- ☐ We explain all four user types and what each one does.
- ☐ We explain our authentication design, including alumni verification and administrator provisioning.
- ☐ We include and explain our system architecture diagram.
- ☐ We justify our database choice.
- ☐ We justify our mobile framework choice.
- ☐ We explain the design and purpose of the AI profile assistant/chatbot.
- ☐ We include analytics dashboard slides for the different user types.
- ☐ We explain POPIA/data privacy compliance and how user information is protected.
- ☐ The presentation is visually professional, consistent and easy to follow.

13. Live Demo & Presentation Readiness(10 points)

- ☐ Every team member has a speaking/presenting role.
- ☐ We have rehearsed the demo in the same order we plan to present it.
- ☐ The live demo covers the Student user type.
- ☐ The live demo covers the Alumni user type.
- ☐ The live demo covers the Business user type.
- ☐ The live demo covers the Administrator panel/user type.
- ☐ We narrate what we are doing so the judging panel is never left guessing what a feature does.
- ☐ We have tested the demo flow and removed obvious critical failures.

- [ ] We are prepared to complete the full presentation and demo within the 30–45 minute slot.

Final Team Check

- [ ] Every box above has been checked, or we have identified exactly what still needs to be completed.
- [ ] We have tested the complete app from a fresh start/login rather than only testing isolated screens.
- [ ] We have prepared backup demo data/accounts where appropriate without faking core functionality.
- [ ] We are ready to explain and justify how the important features work, not only show the interface.